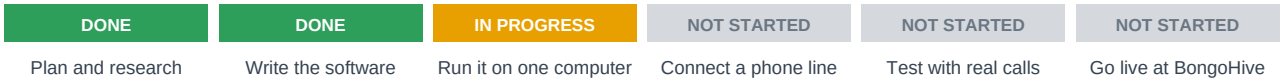
Buzz: where we are and what is left

A plain-language progress summary, 21 October 2026

The short version

Buzz is BongoHive's AI phone receptionist. It will answer calls, give out information about BongoHive, take messages, pass callers to staff, and stop calling anyone who asks it to. Everything runs on BongoHive's own computers, so calls and recordings are never sent to outside companies.

The design and the software are written and have passed their automatic checks. This week we started running the whole system on one laptop to see it work. It is not yet answering real phone calls. The biggest remaining pieces are the phone line, testing with real conversations, and moving to proper servers.



What is finished

Piece	What it means
The plan	We studied the open-source platform Buzz is built on and found five places where it would have sent information to outside companies. Each one now has a fix, so privacy is built in.
The software	All the parts are written: the receptionist's behaviour, the "do not call" list, the phone-system setup, privacy checks, monitoring and backups. More than 400 automatic checks pass.
What Buzz knows	Buzz now knows real BongoHive information from the website: opening hours (weekdays 8 to 5, Saturday 9 to 1), the address, the programmes, the coworking plans and the AI Lab.
Its rules	Buzz must say it is an AI, never ask for PINs or card numbers, never make up an answer, and stop calling anyone who asks. These rules are written into its instructions.
The branding	The Buzz logo and the BongoHive AI Lab look are done and used in the system.

What is happening now (in progress)

We are running the whole system on one Mac laptop with no cloud services, so we can see Buzz working before buying servers. So far:

Piece	Status
The AI "brain"	Installed and answering questions on the laptop (a 7-billion-parameter open model).

Piece	Status
The main system	Running: the web control panel, the database, the call engine and the voice-calling parts are all up.
A small problem	The "do not call" list service keeps restarting because of a file-permission mistake. This is a quick fix and is next.
Still to do on the laptop	Create the first admin login, connect the AI and the voice to the control panel, load the receptionist, and make a test call from the web browser.

What is left

Step	What it involves	Rough time
1. Finish the laptop trial	Fix the small problem, then talk to Buzz through the browser and check it answers correctly and quickly.	A few days
2. Test the conversations	Run 18 practice conversations (50 before launch): hours questions, price questions it should not guess, "stop calling me", asking for a person, and tricky callers.	About a week
3. Real servers	Move to proper computers with a graphics card so Buzz is fast enough for several calls at once. The laptop is slower and only for trying things out.	Needs hardware
4. The phone line	Pick a phone provider and number, connect it, and make about 14 test calls, checking that the AI-disclosure message plays first.	Needs a provider
5. Safety and privacy checks	Prove nothing leaves BongoHive's network, test the "do not call" list, check recordings are protected, and test backups.	About a week
6. Pilot, then go live	Start with a few real callers and staff watching, fix what we find, then launch.	After 1 to 5

What we need from BongoHive

Item	Question
A phone provider	Which company will supply the phone line and number, and can they block expensive international numbers?
Server details	Where the real servers will be, or a go-ahead to rent temporary cloud ones for testing.
Phone numbers	The website shows two different phone numbers. Which is the right one for callers? Also the staff extensions Buzz should transfer to.
Missing facts	Coworking prices (may Buzz quote them?), how to apply for each programme, dates of the next events, and who handles which topic.
Decisions	The web address Buzz will use, how long to keep recordings (we propose 90 days), and where alerts should go (email, Slack or WhatsApp).

Things to be aware of

• **Speed.** On a laptop, replies will feel slower than on real servers. We will measure the real speed once the servers exist.
• **The phone line is untested.** The laptop has no phone provider, so phone calls will be tested later. The browser test uses the same brain and voice.
• **Languages.** Buzz speaks English for now. Bemba and Nyanja are planned for later.
• **Brand on the control panel.** For the laptop trial the panel shows the Dograh logo, not Buzz. The Buzz-branded version needs a longer build, which we will do when the network allows.
• **Network.** Slow downloads have delayed setup, but nothing is broken.